



Senior Platform Engineer and Technical Mentor

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jimbocalder

Halifax, NS • Remote

Summary

Platform engineer with 12 years of experience building internal developer tooling, cloud automation, and resilient delivery pipelines for product teams in fintech, health tech, and public-sector environments. Known for making complicated systems operable, writing clear technical documentation, and mentoring engineers across backend, infrastructure, and release workflows.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Go, TypeScript, SQL, PowerShell

Cloud and DevOps: Azure, GitHub Actions, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes

Practices: Incident response, Observability, Technical mentoring, Architecture reviews

Experience

Senior Platform Engineer

2022 – present

Northshore Pay Systems

Python / Azure / Terraform / GitHub Actions / PostgreSQL

- Led migration from hand-managed cloud resources to Terraform modules used by six delivery teams.
- Cut failed deployment recovery time by introducing reusable rollout and rollback workflows.
- Built internal documentation and office-hour processes that reduced platform support interruptions during releases.

DevOps Engineer

2018 – 2022

Maple Harbor Health

Go / Kubernetes / Helm / Prometheus / Grafana

- Implemented cluster observability dashboards and alert tuning for patient-facing services.
- Standardized service templates so new teams could ship production-ready APIs with fewer manual steps.
- Partnered with developers to convert brittle shell automation into tested Go utilities.

Software Developer

2014 – 2018

Civic Ledger Labs

TypeScript / Node.js / SQL Server / Azure DevOps

- Delivered workflow tools for records management and service intake across municipal departments.
- Introduced pull-request templates and release notes conventions that improved auditability.
- Mentored junior developers on debugging, testing strategy, and maintainable API design.

Projects

Runbook Navigator

2025

Prototype assistant that indexes platform runbooks and links answers back to source documentation for support staff.

Technologies: Python, Azure AI Search, Markdown

Release Scorecard

2024

Internal dashboard that summarizes change risk, test coverage signals, and rollback readiness before production deployments.

Technologies: TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Power BI

Education

- **Master of Applied Computing** – Dalhousie University 2012 – 2014 *Distributed Systems Thesis: Operational Patterns for Small-Team Cloud Platforms*
- **Bachelor of Computer Science** – Saint Mary's University 2008 – 2012 *Software Engineering*

Certifications

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate – Microsoft 2024 (ID: AZA-445812)
- CKA: Certified Kubernetes Administrator – The Linux Foundation 2023

Honours & Awards

- Engineering Enablement Award – Northshore Pay Systems 2025

Languages

- **English** – Native
- **French** – Professional working proficiency

Professional Memberships

- CNCF Halifax Meetup (Volunteer Organizer) 2023 – present

Portfolio

-  Platform Writing Samples
-  Automation Lab

AI Expertise

Daily practice:

- Uses code assistants to draft infrastructure changes, then reviews diffs and failure modes before merge.
- Builds retrieval-backed internal support bots over runbooks and incident records.
- Automates repetitive triage summaries for on-call handoff notes and deployment reviews.

What I teach about AI:

- Teaches prompt hygiene, source validation, and safe use of AI output in engineering teams.
- Runs workshops on using AI to accelerate debugging without skipping root-cause analysis.

AI and assessment design (from training):

- Designs team guidelines for acceptable AI use in take-home assessments and documentation tasks.

Volunteer Experience

- **Mentor** 2021 – present
Atlantic Tech Connect
Mentors career changers on cloud fundamentals, portfolio projects, and technical interview preparation.

Publications

- Reducing Deployment Anxiety with Better Operational Feedback (East Coast DevOps Notes) 2024